

CASE ID: 200203710713

EPISODE NAME: China-Taiwan Steel Imports

2002/03/26 - 2008/09/23

Sender: China (710)

Target: Taiwan (713)

Issue: Trade Practices (13)

Final Outcome: Stalemate after Sanctions Imposition (9)

Summarize:

On 2002/03/26, China launched an anti-dumping investigation into cold rolled steel products from Taiwan, South Korea, Russia, Ukraine and Kazakhstan. The investigation found Taiwan and all other countries guilty, and so China imposed anti-dumping tariffs on 2004/01/14. The sanctions expired on 2008/09/23, without Taiwan or any other countries having retaliated.

Narrative:

On 2003/09/23, China imposed anti-dumping tariffs of up to 55 percent on cold rolled steel products from Taiwan, South Korea, Russia, Ukraine and Kazakhstan.¹

The initial onset of the episode began on 2002/03/26, when China's Ministry of Foreign Trade and Economic Cooperation announced the beginning of an anti-dumping investigation into the five countries' cold-rolled steel, following allegations from Chinese steel conglomerates.²

The investigation found all countries involved guilty of dumping cold-rolled steel into the Chinese market, with China's Ministry of Commerce explaining that, "the ministry has decided that dumping of such products does exist, and has caused substantial damage."³

Chinese steel company Wuhan Steel welcomed the decision, saying that, "the decision will have a positive impact on the company's operations and production."⁴ Other Chinese steel companies, such as Shanghai Baosteel Group Corporation and Anshan Iron & Steel Group, alongside the aforementioned Wuhan Steel, had lobbied China to open a probe into steel imports.⁵

The sanctions expired on 2008/09/23.⁶ None of the countries are reported to have retaliated.

¹ Shen, Ben. "China Ends Anti-dumping Taxes on Imported Steel Plates." *CENS*, September 25th, 2008. https://www.cens.com/cens/html/en/news/news_inner_24793.html.

² Richard Dobson, "China Looks into Reports of Dumping," *Taipei Times*, March 27th, 2002, <https://www.taipeitimes.com/News/biz/archives/2002/03/27/0000129449>.

³ "China slaps duties on steel," *CNN*, January 14th, 2004, <https://www.cnn.com/2004/BUSINESS/01/14/china.steel.reut/>.

⁴ Ibid.

⁵ Richard Dobson, "China Looks into Reports of Dumping," *Taipei Times*, March 27th, 2002, <https://www.taipeitimes.com/News/biz/archives/2002/03/27/0000129449>.

⁶ "中华人民共和国商务部公告2008年第2号." *Ministry of Commerce of the People's Republic of China*, May 5th, 2008. https://www.mofcom.gov.cn/zcfb/blgg/art/2008/art_078ba845a21a4e058e68d4f452617c87.html.